

1. Escalation Workflow in My Own Words

Escalation workflow is the process of passing a security alert or incident from one level of the security team to a higher level when the current level cannot handle it alone. It is like how in a hospital a nurse first checks the patient and if the problem is serious they call a doctor, and if it is even more serious the doctor calls a specialist. In cybersecurity the same idea applies where a junior analyst first looks at the alert and if it is too complex or too serious they pass it up to a more experienced person.

The purpose of escalation is to make sure that every security incident gets the right level of attention from the right person. Small and simple alerts are handled quickly by junior staff while complex and critical incidents are handled by experienced senior experts. This saves time, uses resources wisely, and ensures that serious threats are never ignored or mishandled.

2. Triage vs Investigation

In cybersecurity triage means looking at an alert, checking basic details, and deciding whether it is a real threat or a false alarm. It is a fast process and does not go into deep detail. The goal is simply to sort and prioritize alerts.

Investigation Investigation is the deep and detailed analysis of an alert that has already been confirmed as a real threat during triage. The investigator digs deeper into the logs, traces the attacker's actions, finds out how the attack happened, what systems were affected, and what data may have been stolen. Investigation takes much more time and requires higher skills and experience than triage.

Key Difference Triage is fast and surface level, its goal is to sort and prioritize. Investigation is deep and detailed, its goal is to fully understand the attack and find its root cause.

3. Real World Scenario with L1, L2, L3 Roles

Scenario: Suspicious Login from a Foreign Country

One morning the SIEM tool of a large banking company generated an alert saying that a user account called "john.doe" had successfully logged in from Russia at 3 AM even though this user always logs in from India during office hours.

L1 Analyst — Triage

The L1 analyst is the first person to see the alert. They do a quick check and look at the basic details of the alert. They confirm that the login did happen from an unusual location and at an

unusual time. They also check that this is not a known VPN address used by the company. Since this looks suspicious and beyond their handling level they classify it as a medium to high severity alert and escalate it to the L2 analyst for deeper investigation. L1 did not spend too much time on it, their job was just to identify and escalate.

L2 Analyst — Investigation

The L2 analyst receives the escalated alert and begins a deeper investigation. They pull out the full login logs of the user account and notice that within the same hour there were login attempts from both India and Russia which is impossible for a real person since both locations are thousands of kilometers apart. This is called an impossible travel alert. They also check if any sensitive files were accessed or any money transfers were initiated after the login. They confirm this is a real threat and a possible account takeover attack. Since this involves a compromised user account in a bank which is a critical situation they escalate it to the L3 expert for advanced handling.

L3 Expert — Response and Resolution

The L3 expert is the most experienced person on the team. They immediately disable the compromised account to stop any further damage. They trace the attacker's activity step by step through the logs to find out exactly what the attacker accessed, whether any customer data was stolen, and how the attacker got the login credentials in the first place. They discover that the user had fallen for a phishing email that stole their password. The L3 expert then leads the full incident response, coordinates with the bank management, notifies affected customers if needed, patches the vulnerability, and writes a full incident report with recommendations to prevent this from happening again.

Summary Table

Level	Role	Action Taken
L1 Analyst	Triage	Spotted unusual login, classified severity, escalated
L2 Analyst	Investigation	Found impossible travel, confirmed account takeover, escalated
L3 Expert	Response	Disabled account, traced attack, led full incident response